

# JSS2 English Language Diagnostic Bank (Part 1)

**Curriculum Scope:** Cambridge Lower Secondary (Stage 8) & Nigerian JSS2

**Focus:** Mastery of Grammar, Syntax, and Advanced Mechanics

## Cluster 1: Grammar, Concord & Complex Sentence Structure (Questions 1 - 20)

| No. | Question & Options                                                                                                                                                                                             | Ans | Diagnostic Purpose / Sub-topic                           |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|----------------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | Choose the correct form: "Neither the captain nor the sailors ____ aware of the storm."<br>A) is B) was C) were D) has been                                                                                    | C   | Concord: Proximity rule with "nor".                      |
| 2   | Identify the passive voice version: "The chef prepared a grand meal."<br>A) A grand meal is prepared. B) A grand meal was prepared by the chef. C) The chef was preparing a meal. D) A meal had been prepared. | B   | Active vs. Passive Voice transformation.                 |
| 3   | "If he had studied harder, he ____ the exam." Choose the correct tense.<br>A) would pass B) will pass C) would have passed D) had passed                                                                       | C   | Third Conditional (Expressing regret/hypothetical past). |
| 4   | Select the correct Reported Speech: "I am tired," John said.<br>A) John said that he is tired. B) John said that he was tired. C) John says he was tired. D) John told he was tired.                           | B   | Direct to Indirect Speech transition.                    |
| 5   | Choose the correct relative pronoun: "The house, ____ roof was damaged, is being repaired."<br>A) which B) whose C) that D) whom                                                                               | B   | Relative Pronouns (Possessive).                          |
| 6   | Identify the transitive verb in the sentence: "She bought a new dress for the party."<br>A) bought B) dress C) party D) for                                                                                    | A   | Transitive vs. Intransitive Verbs.                       |
| 7   | Choose the correctly punctuated sentence:<br>A) Its a long way to the city's center. B) It's a long way to the city's center. C) Its' a long way to the citys center. D) It's a long way to the cities center. | B   | Punctuation: Apostrophes (Contraction vs. Possession).   |
| 8   | Which of these contains a gerund?<br>A) He is swimming in the pool. B) Swimming is his favorite hobby. C) They will go swimming. D) I saw him swimming.                                                        | B   | Gerunds vs. Present Participles.                         |
| 9   | Choose the correct order of adjectives: "She bought a ____ bag."<br>A) leather, black, big B) big, black, leather C) black, big, leather D) leather, big, black                                                | B   | Order of Adjectives (Size, Color, Material).             |

| No. | Question & Options                                                                                                                                           | Ans | Diagnostic Purpose / Sub-topic                  |
|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|-------------------------------------------------|
| 10  | "The news ___ very distressing to the public."<br>A) are B) were C) is D) have been                                                                          | C   | Uncountable nouns and Verb agreement.           |
| 11  | Identify the type of phrase underlined: "The man <u>with the red hat</u> is my uncle."<br>A) Noun phrase B) Adjective phrase C) Adverb phrase D) Verb phrase | B   | Phrasal Analysis.                               |
| 12  | "Hardly had I sat down ___ the phone rang."<br>A) than B) when C) then D) that                                                                               | B   | Correlative Conjunctions (Negative inversions). |
| 13  | Choose the reflexive pronoun: "The children organized the party ____."<br>A) theirselves B) themselves C) ourself D) himself                                 | B   | Reflexive Pronouns.                             |
| 14  | Select the correct question tag: "You haven't finished the work, ___?"<br>A) haven't you B) have you C) did you D) do you                                    | B   | Question Tags (Negative to Positive).           |
| 15  | Which word is an abstract noun?<br>A) Teacher B) Classroom C) Knowledge D) Book                                                                              | C   | Noun classification.                            |
| 16  | "He ran fast so that he wouldn't miss the bus." The underlined part is a clause of:<br>A) Time B) Reason C) Purpose D) Condition                             | C   | Subordinate Clauses (Purpose).                  |
| 17  | Choose the correct preposition: "I am tired ___ waiting for the results."<br>A) with B) at C) of D) by                                                       | C   | Prepositional collocations.                     |
| 18  | Identify the intensified adverb: "The cheetah runs <u>incredibly</u> fast."<br>A) runs B) incredibly C) fast D) cheetah                                      | B   | Adverbs of degree.                              |
| 19  | "I prefer tea ___ coffee."<br>A) than B) over C) to D) for                                                                                                   | C   | Comparative preference structures.              |
| 20  | Which sentence uses the present perfect continuous tense?<br>A) I have eaten. B) I am eating. C) I have been eating. D) I had been eating.                   | C   | Tense identification and usage.                 |